



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Mozambique: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-06 · 26 systems and instruments tracked, 32 of them not held

*Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-06 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.*

## Summary of the month

The Constitutional Council struck down the Telecommunications Traffic Control Regulations on 29 July 2026, holding that the Act relied on as their legal base authorises no structural and permanent surveillance of communications ([judgment](#)). The communications minister said on 3 August that the government respects the decision ([ministerial statement](#)), and the government spokesman said the next day that it will now seek the same end by another route, naming no bill, instrument or timetable ([government response](#)).

Three systems entered or extended service in the same five weeks: the National Payments System Law took effect on 2 July, a university data centre was inaugurated on 3 August, and free issuance of identity documents was extended to 2027. The minister responsible told a Maputo conference on 28 July that current national compute, data centres included, cannot support more advanced artificial-intelligence models ([ministerial account](#)).

## Infrastructure

The regulator opened a public geospatial broadband coverage portal on 22 July 2026, built with two commercial suppliers, letting the public check operator coverage and speeds by location and report gaps ([regulator communique](#)). No usage or gap-report figure has been published since.

The country's first university-operated data centre was inaugurated on 3 August with about 14 times the storage of the server room it replaces, precision cooling, redundant systems and grid, photovoltaic and generator supply ([inauguration account](#)). It is World Bank financed with no amount, operation name or project number stated. At the same event the communications minister put the research and education network MoRENet at [60 Gbps, funded for a fifteen-year term](#) — a single account of the same remarks reported 100 Gbit/s and attributed it to the country rather than to the network, and that figure is not carried — and proposed transferring management of the research and education network from his own ministry to the universities, naming no date, instrument or governance model ([ministerial account](#)).

A carrier-neutral operator announced on 23 July that a wholesale network will co-locate in its Mozambican and Angolan facilities, with no deployment date, capacity or value stated ([partnership announcement](#)).

## Digital public infrastructure

The National Payments System Law took effect on 2 July 2026, replacing the regime in force since 2008 and extending the central bank's inspection and supervision over electronic-money institutions and new payment service providers ([enactment account](#)). On 30 July the central bank reported the instant payment system carrying more than 11,000 transfers a day, a tripling since it entered production in March ([communique account](#)).

The identification directorate reported on 23 July that it produced 856,101 identity cards in the first half of 2026 on 813,307 applications, against 730,527 a year earlier, with 297,470 issued free ([directorate account](#)). On 28 July the President extended free issuance of the identity card, birth certificate and personal certificate to 2027, stating neither the end month nor the deadline it replaces ([presidential announcement](#)).

The tax authority made the fiscal clearance certificate available online from 3 August with a ten working-day issuance ceiling and a published complaints address ([authority account](#)). The statistics institute opened enumerator training on 27 July for a census pilot running 1-15 August, testing procedures for a 2027 census it states will be the first run entirely in digital format ([training account](#)).

## Governance and regulation

Beyond the Constitutional Council ruling, the month's governance record is the institute's own account of the two 2026 statutes, given at a police academy seminar on 23 July: the Cyber Security Law is Law 13/2026 and the Cybercrime Law is Law 14/2026, the first creating the national incident response team and seating its operation inside the institute, and the National Cyber Security Strategy 2026-2030 is under revision, succeeding a policy whose own period ended in 2025 ([institute account](#)).

On 22 July the communications minister told a banking and finance conference that the country is consolidating its legal and institutional framework, naming the personal data protection law and a national data governance policy as the two instruments in preparation, and warned that once approved they will place obligations on companies and not only on the state ([ministerial account](#)). Mozambique remained without a data protection law in force, with no tabling or adoption date stated.

The regulator opened a free public device-identity lookup on 4 August, checked against a registry held by an industry association ([regulator notice](#)). The notice sets out no type approval, import control, blocking regime or penalty.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Mozambique signed the agreement establishing the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization in Shanghai on 16 July 2026, as one of 29 founding member states and one of ten African ones ([signing account](#)). No ratification step, entry-into-force date or contribution is stated in the held account.

The Intellectual Property Policy and Strategy 2026-2035, approved by resolution on 30 June and reported on 22 July, mandates a study on the impact of the digital environment and artificial intelligence on the intellectual property framework, including the patentability of inventions made by artificial intelligence, and costs legal and institutional modernisation at 719.6m meticaïs ([approval account](#)). The resolution and strategy text are not held, and every provision and figure is the reporting agency's reading of the document.

On 28 July the communications minister told a banking and finance conference that current national infrastructure, data centres included, cannot support more advanced artificial-intelligence models, and listed cloud-computing and radio-centre regulations alongside the two 2026 statutes as mandatory for operators of critical infrastructure ([ministerial account](#)).

## Inclusion, capacity and finance

The central bank's Financial Inclusion Report 2025, reported on 24 July, counted 482,359 financial access points, up 36% on 2024, of which 446,604 were non-bank agents against 315,005 the year before, while automated teller machines fell from 1,391 to 1,383 and card terminals from 35,486 to 32,236 ([report account](#)). Mobile money reached 1,313 accounts per thousand adults against 337 bank accounts, and the national Financial Inclusion Index held flat at 36.4 points.

Agent growth was fastest in the least-served provinces, and the report set that against a widening credit gap: women's participation in credit rose from 31% to 34% while men's rose from 59% to 66%, even as women's mobile money holding rose 24%.

The institute reported on 23 July that under the World Bank-funded acceleration project 14 training actions had benefited 30 of its technicians and 2,032 professionals from public bodies, private firms and the media had received cyber-security training, with 14 national specialists holding an international incident-response certification ([institute account](#)). The period those cumulative figures cover is not stated.

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